Achievement EHCP TARGET progression mapping

Comparison Strand Overview

The comparison strand focuses on developing pupils' understanding of quantity by learning to notice, explore and evaluate differences between groups of objects. It begins with early sensory awareness of change (e.g. noticing when there is more or less) and progresses towards actively comparing quantities, using strategies such as matching or counting, and eventually explaining and justifying decisions using mathematical language. This strand supports pupils in moving from intuitive responses to more deliberate and reasoned mathematical thinking.

Why is it important?

Comparison is the thinking side of maths. It underpins problem solving, reasoning, and understanding "how much bigger/smaller".

Without this - Pupils can complete tasks but don't understand what results mean

With it - Pupils understand relationships between quantities

Pathway Aim –

By the end of the pathway, pupils will be able to compare and order quantities accurately and explain their reasoning using appropriate mathematical language and strategies in a range of practical contexts.

Example evidence statements –

"The pupil can order three groups of objects from smallest to largest independently."
"They use 'greater than' and 'less than' correctly when comparing numbers to 20."
"They explain their reasoning using counting and grouping strategies."

Awareness of Difference →	**Direct Comparison** →	**Reasoning & Ordering**
(Bands 1 → 4 emerging) Pupils notice and respond to differences in quantity through sensory experiences. They are not yet comparing intentionally.	**(Bands 4 → 6)** Pupils compare two groups using practical strategies such as matching or counting and identify which is more, fewer or equal.	**(Bands 6 → 7)** Pupils compare and order multiple quantities and explain their thinking using mathematical vocabulary and reasoning.
Key stage Target By the end of the key stage, the pupil will demonstrate an awareness of differences in quantity by noticing, reacting to and	**Key stage Target** By the end of the key stage, the pupil will directly compare two groups of objects using practical strategies (e.g. matching, grouping)	**Key stage Target** By the end of the key stage, the pupil will compare and order multiple quantities and explain their reasoning using appropriate

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anticipating changes in amount during practical and sensory experiences.	and identify which has more, fewer or if they are equal.	mathematical vocabulary (e.g. greater than, less than, equal to).
Typical evidence might include: • reacting to changes (e.g. more objects added) • anticipating continuation different responses to one vs many	**Typical evidence might include:** • matching objects to compare • identifying more/fewer/equal • counting to check	**Typical evidence might include:** • ordering 3+ groups • explaining "how they know" • using mathematical vocabulary
Mapped curriculum targets **Band 1 -** • I can react to changes in amount when they are significant • I can respond to objects appearing or disappearing • I can notice when something has been added or taken away • I can show anticipation when more objects are presented • I can attend to objects being moved or changed • I can demonstrate awareness of "more" through looking, reaching or vocalising **Band 2 –** • I can follow objects or sounds as they are counted or moved • I can respond to words like more • I can anticipate when more items are added • I can respond differently to one object and many objects • I can look for things that have moved out of sight **Band 3 –** • I can combine small groups and notice there are more	**Mapped curriculum targets** **Band 4 -** • I can begin to compare groups • I can use language such as more, same and different • I can compare two groups by matching objects **Band 5 –** • I can compare groups up to 5 • I can match objects to compare • I can identify which group has more • I can identify when groups are equal • I can identify which group has fewer **Band 6 -** • I can compare quantities up to 10 • I can identify more and fewer • I can compare without counting by using grouping or matching	**Mapped curriculum targets** **Band 6 –** • I can begin to estimate **Band 7 -** • I can compare quantities • I can use greater than, less than, equal to • I can explain comparisons • I can order more than two groups or numbers

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• I can notice when a group becomes bigger or smaller **Band 4 –** • I can notice when groups change		
Next Step: begin intentional comparison of two groups	**Next Step:** explain and justify comparisons and order multiple quantities	**Next Step:** Apply comparison and ordering skills to numbers, measures and representations, including using symbols and solving problems involving greater/less relationships